PROM02: Computing Master's Project

Assessment 1 – Planning

University of Sunderland

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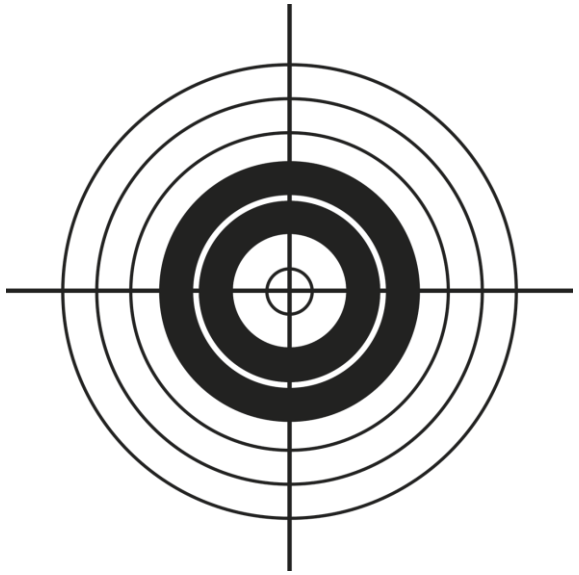
Objectives

- In this session we will cover:
  - What is the planning review?
  - How does it relate to the project proposal?
  - What does it consist of?
  - How to complete the project schedule
  - Completing the evaluation plan
  - What is SEPLi?



Overview

- Assessment 1 – Planning is worth 10%
- Planning Review Submission Marks
  - Section 1 : Terms of Reference – 50%
  - Section 2: Project Schedule – 20%
  - Section 3 : Evaluation Plan – 10%
  - Section 4 : SEPLi – 20%
    - Social, Ethical Professional and Legal issues
- Each section has an assigned word limit

Section 1: Terms of Reference – (50%)

- **1.1 Project Title**
  - Clear and understandable
  - Describes the project
  - Look at the title of research papers for inspiration

- **1.2 Project Overview**
  - **Aim/s**
    - What do you intend to do / achieve overall in your project.
    - Must incorporate research and practice.

Section 1: Terms of Reference – (50%)

- **1.2 Project Overview continued**
  - **Objectives**
    - Between 5 – 8 bulletpoints
    - SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, Time-Bound)
    - Identify what you want to achieve and the related deliverables
    - Objectives should be linked to the aim/s and your research question
    - You will be evaluating your overall project against these objectives

  - **Research Question**
    - Must be a question and must be answerable through:
      - Proposed literature focus
      - Practical work
      - Exploration / activities you undertake in your project

Example Research Questions

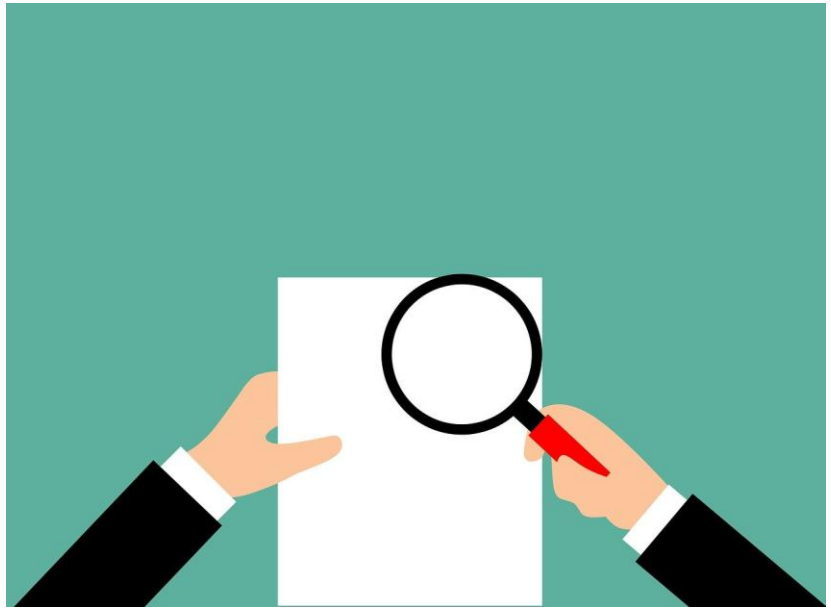
- *What are the perceived risks of cloud-based storage systems?*
- *What are the effects of VR and AR integration within the Computer Science classroom?*
- *Which AI techniques are currently used in breast cancer detection and can they improve diagnostic accuracy?*

Section 1: Terms of Reference (50%)

- **1.2 Project Overview continued**
  - **Practical Outcome**
    - Up to 5 bullet points detailing your practical outputs or key deliverables
    - For example: If your main practical outcome is creating software you may have the following outcomes:
      - Requirements Analysis
      - A range of design specification documents
      - An initial prototype
      - Testing documentation
      - Refined prototype

Section 1: Terms of Reference (50%)

- **1.3 Literature Review**
  - Annotated bibliography of 10 high quality research papers you have read that are relevant to your project**.**
    - Correct citation – Harvard referencing style
    - Summary of the paper (in your own words)
    - Relevance to YOUR research question
    - Relevance to YOUR practical outcome.



Section 2: Project Schedule – 20%

- **Section 2.1 Effort**
  - Tables in the template need to be edited to include your information
    - What are the major / main tasks and how will you decompose them?
      - How much time do you anticipate spending on each sub-task?
      - When do you plan on starting and finishing the tasks?
      - What are the outcomes (deliverables) of task
        - Deliverables must be tangible and something you can evidence.

Task Id	Task Name	Start	Deadline	Hours	Deliverable
1.0 Major Task Name (mapped to objectives / method)					
1.1					
1.2					
1.3					
Etc.					
2.0 Major Task Name (mapped to objectives / method)					
2.1					
Etc.					

Section 2 : Project Schedule – 20%

- **Section 2.1 Effort**
  - Remember to add the **deliverables** from **Table 1: Effort** into **Table 2 : Deliverables**
    - **They must be the same set of deliverables in each table!**
  - Use the **major task names** from **Table 1 : Effort** to create the first column in **Table 4: Outline Schedule / Gantt Chart.**
- **All of the tables in Section 2 should be consistent with major task names, deliverables and timelines**

Section 2 : Project Schedule – 20%

- **Section 2.2: Deliverables**
  - Deliverables are the outcomes of your research and practical work
    - For example:
      - Literature Review in Machine Learning
      - Review of algorithms to enable prediction in health datasets
      - Dataset selection and cleaning
      - Etc.
    - Often indicate the ending of tasks
    - Consistent nomenclature is important
      - Task 1 Deliverable 1 could be D1.1, etc
    - Should be added / consistent with the final column of Table 1:Effort
    - Consistent with Table 2.4 Outline Schedule

Del. No.	Name	Deadline
D1	Requirements Specification	10/10/2055
D2	Data Cleansing Protocol	
D3	Clustering Results	
D4	Data Evaluation	

Section 2: Project Schedule – 20%

- **Section 2.3 Milestones**
  - Indicators that there is progress
  - A way to identify when you have completed something
  - Add milestones in chronological order
  - Identify how you will know these have been achieved (evidence)
  - Consistent nomenclature and representation
  - **Remember to include the milestones in Section 2.4 Outline Schedule**

Milestone	Name	Deadline	Evidence
M1			Specify what deliverable or event used to identify that the milestone has been met

Section 2: Project Schedule – 20%

- **Section 2.4 Outline Schedule / Gantt Chart**

	June					July				August				September	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Major Task 1		MS1	D1.1						D1.2						
Major Task 2				MS2			D2.1				D2.2				
Major Task 3					D3.1					D3.2				D3.3	

	October					November				December				January	
	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	26	28	129	30
Major Task 4		MS4	D4.1						D4.2						
Major Task 5				MS5			D5.1				D5.2				
User Testing					D6.1					D6.2				D6.3	

IMPORTANT

- Ensure there is consistency between tables 1, 2, 3 and the project schedule in 4.
- Ensure you have the correct duration for the programme route you are on.

- Add the task names from **Table 1** into **Column 1**.
- Shade the rows to indicate task length.
- Identify where you have **milestones** and **deliverables** and add them in.

Section 3: Evaluation Plan – 10%

- **Evaluation Plan**
  - Use the template provided – max 1 page.
  - Use your **Objectives from Section 1.2** as the first column in the table

  - For each objective:
    - What was the ‘M’ in your SMART objective?
    - How will you know you have succeeded?
    - How do you demonstrate objectives reached?
    - What evidence will you provide?

Objective	Evaluation Approach	Evidence
List each objective specified in your terms of reference	For each objective, specify how you will evaluate achievement identifying how you will generate and use evidence to demonstrate that objectives have been met.	Identify the evidence that you will collect and create. This can include deliverables and outputs including design documentation, questionnaires, literature review, testing reports, presentations, sign-off documentation, approved meeting minutes, etc.

Section 4: Social, Ethical, Professional and Legal Issues – 20%

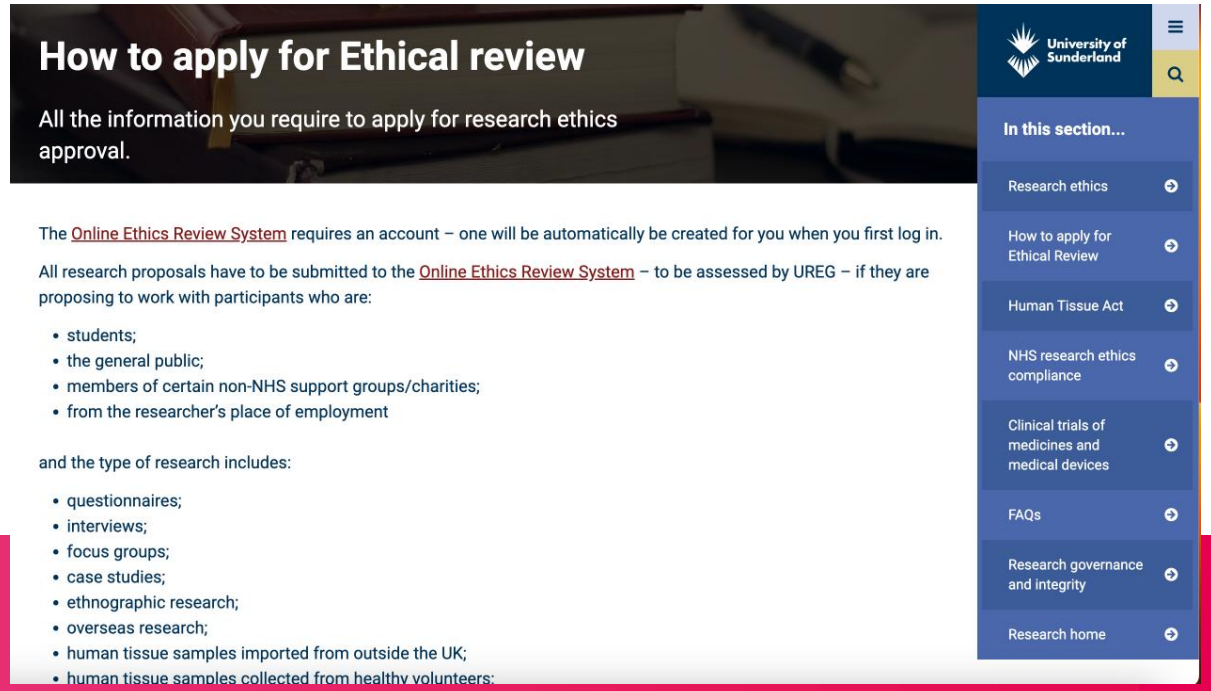
- All projects have Social, Ethical, Professional and Legal Issues.
- 100 words max per section (4 sections)
- **Social Considerations:**
  - Context of your project?
  - Sociotechnical concerns?
  - Data ethics
- **Ethical Considerations:**
  - Recruiting participants?
  - Research methodology
- **Professional Considerations:**
  - ACM Code of Conduct (https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics)
  - Student / Supervisor relationship
- **Legal Considerations:**
  - Legislation such as GDPR and Data Protection Act

Social issues	*Provide up to 100 words on Social issues related to your project if any.*
Ethical issues	*Provide up to 100 words on Ethical issues related to your project if any.*
Professional issues	*Provide up to 100 words on Professional issues related to your project if any.*
Legal Issues	*Provide up to 100 words on Legal issues related to your project if any.*

Ethical Approval Process

- Ethics applications must go through the University Online Ethics Review System:
  https://www.sunderland.ac.uk/more/research/research-governance-integrity/ethics/apply-ethical-review/

- Further guidance on this process is available on Canvas → Units → Guidance Documents → **Ethics Guidance**



How to apply for Ethical review

All the information you require to apply for research ethics approval.

The Online Ethics Review System requires an account – one will be automatically be created for you when you first log in.

All research proposals have to be submitted to the Online Ethics Review System – to be assessed by UREG – if they are proposing to work with participants who are:

- students;
- the general public;
- members of certain non-NHS support groups/charities;
- from the researcher's place of employment

and the type of research includes:

- questionnaires;
- interviews;
- focus groups;
- case studies;
- ethnographic research;
- overseas research;
- human tissue samples imported from outside the UK;
- human tissue samples collected from healthy volunteers;

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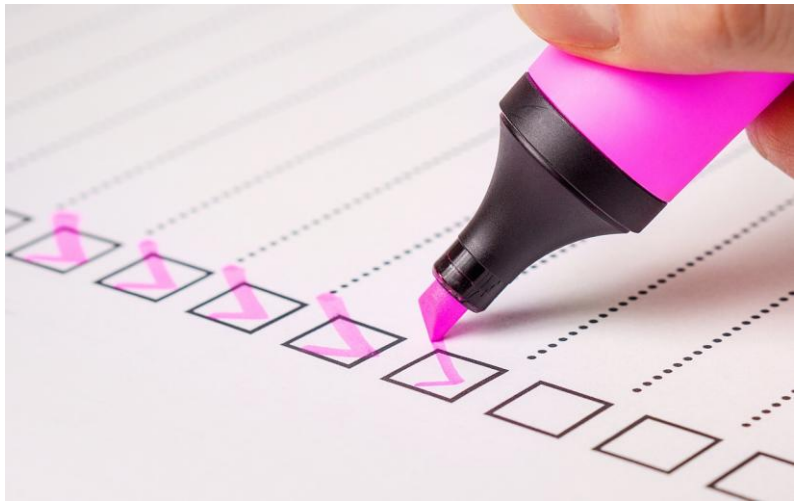
In this section...

- Research ethics
- How to apply for Ethical Review
- Human Tissue Act
- NHS research ethics compliance
- Clinical trials of medicines and medical devices
- FAQs
- Research governance and integrity
- Research home

Summary

- Detailed, prescriptive assignment
- Follow the guidance and use the template provided
- Ensure you complete every section
- Ensure that you are consistent
  - In planning the project
  - In the objectives, deliverables, milestones and schedule
- Remember to include appendices and references as appropriate
  - Harvard referencing style



Questions?